SOCIOECONOMIC FALSE BELIEF #50 · PROSPERITY AND BLESSING

“Struggling financially means I'm out of God's will.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Many believers equate being in God’s will with everything falling into place. When a job ends or money gets tight, they wonder if they missed a turn. A past decision, such as a career move, a risky purchase, or an act of disobedience, can seem to be the cause, and the worry becomes a constant question: “Did I get out of God’s will?”

What Scripture teaches

Scripture says, “I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope.” Proverbs says, “A man’s heart plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps.” The psalmist says, “The steps of a man are ordered by the LORD... Though he falls, he will not be overwhelmed, for the LORD is holding his hand.” Paul, who was in God’s will, was shipwrecked, imprisoned, and often in need. Hardship does not prove we have wandered off the path.

> *“The steps of a man are ordered by the LORD who takes delight in his journey. Though he falls, he will not be overwhelmed, for the LORD is holding his hand”* (Psalm 37:23–24).

Also see

> “For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope” (Jeremiah 29:11).

> “A man’s heart plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps” (Proverbs 16:9).

> “And we know that God works all things together for the good of those who love Him, who are called according to His purpose” (Romans 8:28).

> “Though the fig tree does not bud and no fruit is on the vines, though the olive crop fails and the fields produce no food, though the sheep are cut off from the fold and no cattle are in the stalls, yet I will exult in the LORD; I will rejoice in the God of my salvation!” (Habakkuk 3:17–18).

Common self-statements

- I must have missed God’s direction.
- This is what happens when I step out of His will.
- If I were in His will, things would be smoother.
- I made a wrong turn and ruined everything.
- God is not guiding me anymore.
- I cannot trust my own decisions.

Common logical errors

- Hindsight bias: Judging past decisions by results I could not know.
- All-or-nothing thinking: Believing I am either perfectly in God’s will or out of it.
- Emotional reasoning: Feeling lost and concluding that I am out of His will.
- Personalization: Blaming myself for circumstances with many causes.

Challenging questions

- What exactly do I believe I did that took me out of God's will?
- Did people in the Bible who followed God face hardship? What does that say?
- What does God promise about directing my steps?
- Is there any known disobedience I need to confess, and what does Scripture say about forgiveness?
- What good has God brought out of past hard times?
- What is one next faithful step?

Truth summary

> God orders the steps of those who follow Him, and when I fall, He holds my hand. Hardship does not prove I am out of His will. I can confess any sin, take the next faithful step, and trust Him to work all things for good.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- Will of God
- Guidance
- Plans
- Trust
- Guilt/Shame

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Trouble/Hardship
- Thinking, Healthy

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> Overcoming Anxiety · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Songs that speak truth to this belief

Just Be Held — Casting Crowns
God's care remains when control, strength, or explanations run out.

Great Is Thy Faithfulness — CeCe Winans
This classic hymn recalls God's steady mercy through changing circumstances.

Living Hope — Phil Wickham
Christ's resurrection and forgiveness provide hope beyond sin and death.

Blessed Assurance — Larry Ford and Lillie Knauls with Gaither
This classic hymn celebrates belonging to Christ and resting in His salvation.

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "Struggling financially means I'm out of God's will"

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Read through each section and check the one that fits you best. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ Date started: _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"Struggling financially means I'm out of God's will." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What decision do I fear was wrong?
- ☐ What does Scripture say about God ordering my steps?
- ☐ Is there sin to confess?
- ☐ What good has God brought from hard times?
- ☐ Who can advise me?
- ☐ What is my next faithful step?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ The Lord orders my steps.
- ☐ He holds my hand when I fall.
- ☐ His plans for me are for a future and a hope.
- ☐ Hardship is not proof I am out of His will.
- ☐ He works all things for good.
- ☐ I can take the next faithful step.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- ☐ **Psalm 37:23–24**
  "The steps of a man are ordered by the LORD who takes delight in his journey. Though he falls, he will not be overwhelmed, for the LORD is holding his hand."
- ☐ **Jeremiah 29:11**
  "For I know the plans I have for you, declares the LORD, plans to prosper you and not to harm you, to give you a future and a hope."
- ☐ **Proverbs 16:9**
  "A man's heart plans his course, but the LORD determines his steps."

A verse I found myself: _____

Practicing the Truth

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5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first four. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- [ ] Make my Truth Card (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- [ ] Memorize my Scripture from Step 4.
- [ ] Listen to one song each day from "Songs that speak truth to this belief" on my card, and fill in my song journal (below).
- [ ] Set reminders to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ A buzz: my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ An everyday event: every time I _____
  - ☐ A visual reminder: something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- [ ] The next faithful step: Each day, write one faithful step you can take today.
- [ ] My name in Scripture: Write a personal reminder based on my verse and read it aloud. Keep this application separate from the Bible quotation.

  For example, Psalm 37:23–24 becomes: "Sarah can write: "Though I fall, the Lord is holding my hand.""
- [ ] Gratitude journal: Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- [ ] Truth recording: Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- [ ] Reading: The "Will of God" topic in Pearls.
- [ ] Listening: The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

This card is educational and is not financial or legal advice. Choose steps you can do safely. If you are without food, housing, or safety, contact your church, a trusted advisor, or local assistance services.

- [ ] Write the fear. Describe the decision you fear took you out of God's will.
- [ ] Confess and receive. If there is sin, confess it and receive forgiveness.
- [ ] Seek counsel. Ask a wise friend or pastor for perspective on your next steps.
- [ ] Pray Psalm 37:23–24. Ask Him to order your steps.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

_____

What I learned: _____

The lie "Struggling financially means I'm out of God's will": _____ % My truth: _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	A faithful step
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My song journal

After each day's song, write what it told you that challenges the lie.

Day	Song I listened to	What it told me that challenges the lie
Mon		
Tue		
Wed		
Thu		
Fri		
Sat		
Sun		

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~Struggling financially means I'm out of God's will.~~

THE TRUTH

GOD'S WORD

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord, You hold my hand. Forgive me where I have strayed, and guide me where I am confused. Order my steps, and help me trust that You are with me in hard times. Amen.

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.